Cold Plunge (Elevé · Polar Recovery) — Treatment SOP

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> Elevé Health has not yet supplied operating instructions for the Polar Recovery plunge. Every setting, limit and product marked [per Elevé protocol — pending] must be completed from Elevé's written protocol and Host training before this SOP is used with guests. Where Elevé guidance is stricter, Elevé guidance applies.

1. Purpose

The cold plunge is a short, deliberate immersion in filtered water held at 5 °C for 2–5 minutes. Guests use it to practise calm under stress and to feel alert afterwards. It is a Reset session and is **always Host-guided**. A guest is never left alone at the plunge.

2. Who may deliver

- A Host trained and signed off by Elevé Health on the Polar Recovery plunge [Elevé training record ref.], with current first aid and CPR [certificate ref.].
- One Host stays at the plunge, within arm's reach, for the whole immersion and exit. That Host does nothing else during this time.
- First visits only after the guest's Healer consultation.

3. Equipment and settings

Item	Setting / detail
Unit	Elevé · Polar Recovery plunge (one unit)
Water temperature	5 °C; acceptable range [per Elevé protocol — pending]
Immersion time	2–5 min; first visit [___] min maximum [per Elevé protocol — pending]
Immersion depth	Head stays above water; depth for first visit [per Elevé protocol — pending]
Water treatment and filtration	[per Elevé protocol — pending] (AUR-SAF-02, section 6.8)
Timer	Visible timer set by the Host
Guest wear	[Swimwear or Aura-branded plunge wear — confirm]; hotel-style Aura-branded slippers to the edge
Ready at the edge	Two Aura-branded towels, a dry robe, a non-slip mat

4. Contraindications summary

Screen every guest with AUR-FRM-03, section 8, and the universal checks.

- Do not proceed: pregnancy; heart conditions, arrhythmia, pacemaker or uncontrolled high blood pressure; Raynaud's phenomenon or cold urticaria; open wounds; alcohol in the last 24 hours; epilepsy not controlled.
- Medical clearance needed: controlled high blood pressure; diabetes; asthma; recent surgery; anxiety or panic disorder.
- Ask about today: a heavy meal just before, feeling unwell, very tired or dehydrated. When in doubt, do not plunge.

> Refer screening questions to the Senior Host on shift, then the General Manager, who may consult the [Medical Director named on the licence].

5. Room and device preparation checklist

☐	Check
☐	Unit within Elevé service date; no fault shown
☐	Water temperature read and logged: _____ °C (AUR-SAF-02, section 9.2)
☐	Sanitiser, pH and clarity logged today; water clear
☐	Surface skimmed; rim, handrail and step wiped
☐	Floor dry; non-slip mat in place; entry and exit clear
☐	Towels, robe and timer ready at the edge
☐	Second Host aware a plunge is starting and free to respond
☐	Phone and AED location known [AED location]

6. Guest preparation

1. Confirm the guest has changed and removed jewellery that may slip off.
2. Explain the cold-shock response: a gasp and fast breathing in the first moments is normal. Long, slow exhales help it pass.
3. Agree the time before entry. Make clear they can step out at any moment.
4. Agree a simple signal for "I'm getting out" and "I'm fine".
5. Never combine breath-holding or fast, forceful breathing with the plunge. Breathwork is never done in or near water.

7. Step-by-step delivery

1. Begin the breathing ritual standing beside the plunge.
   - *"Let's slow everything down first. In for four, out for six."*
2. Check today's state.
   - *"How are you feeling right now? Anything that tells you not today?"*
3. Remind the guest of the plan.
   - *"We've agreed ___ minutes. You're in charge. You can step out whenever you like."*
4. Guide entry slowly using the handrail, one step at a time.
   - *"Hold the rail. Feet first. Slowly. Let the cold arrive."*
5. As the guest lowers in, coach the exhale. Start the timer once they are settled.
   - *"Breathe out long, like through a straw. The gasp will pass. Stay with the exhale."*
6. Talk the guest through calmly, every [___] seconds. Watch face, breathing and colour.
   - *"You're doing well. Shoulders soft. Long breath out."*
7. Give a time cue before the end.
   - *"Thirty seconds left. Keep that easy breath."*
8. Guide the exit using the handrail. Wrap the guest in a towel and robe at once.
   - *"Slowly up. Hold the rail. I've got your robe."*
9. Seat the guest and stay with them for at least [___] min while they rewarm.

8. Monitoring and stop criteria

Help the guest out **at once** if they:

- ask to stop or give the agreed signal
- cannot slow their breathing after the first [___] seconds, or start to panic
- shiver violently, or report numbness, pain, chest discomfort or palpitations
- look confused, very pale or blue around the lips, or stop answering clearly
- lose grip or footing, or appear drowsy

Never let a guest's head go under water. Never leave the plunge, even for a moment. If the second Host is needed, call them. Do not go to them.

Body temperature can keep falling for a short time after leaving cold water. Watch for this during rewarming.

9. Post-session care, refreshments and suggested combinations

- Rewarm gradually: towel, robe, slippers, gentle movement. A warm (not hot) shower if the guest wants one, once steady.
- Offer warm herbal tea or water [menu to confirm].
- Do not send the guest straight into another cold session.

Suggested combinations (see AUR-TRT-11):

- Infrared Sauna → rest → Cold Plunge, the contrast pairing from our website. Order, number of rounds and rest gaps [per Elevé protocol — pending].
- Cold Plunge → rewarm → Guided Breathwork (calm, no breath-holds), once fully warm.
- Do not combine Cold Plunge with Whole-Body Cryotherapy in the same visit unless Elevé protocol permits.

10. Cleaning and reset

Follow AUR-SAF-02, section 6.8.

1. Skim the surface; wipe rim, handrail and step.
2. Check and log the temperature: 5 °C. If outside range [per Elevé protocol — pending], do not use.
3. Dry the floor and replace the mat. Wet floors are the main slip risk.
4. Bag used towels and robe for the in-house laundry.
5. Sign the area off before the next guest.

11. If the unit faults

1. Help the guest out first. The water stays cold if the chiller stops, so leave immediately.
2. Switch off as trained [per Elevé protocol — pending]. Water and electricity: never touch controls with wet hands.
3. Place an "Out of service" sign and cover the plunge [if a cover is fitted].
4. Follow AUR-SOP-09: tell the Senior Host and General Manager, log the fault and contact Elevé support [Elevé support contact].
5. Do not use the plunge if water is cloudy, the temperature is out of range or a test reading fails.

12. Emergency actions

Follow AUR-SAF-04.

- Cold injury or severe shivering: section 4.2.

- Guest unresponsive or in difficulty in the water: call for the second Host, support the head above water and help them out; call 998; follow section 4.11. Bring the AED from [AED location] and dry the chest before use.
- Faint after exit: section 4.1.
- Slip or fall: section 4.6.
- Power failure: section 4.8. Help the guest out at once and warm them.

Complete an Incident Report Form (AUR-SAF-04, section 7) for every incident or near miss.

13. Records

Record	Where it is kept
Screening checklist (AUR-FRM-03)	Guest file [Booking system — to be chosen]
Session log: date, water temperature, agreed and actual time, Host, guest comments	Session log
Temperature and water log	AUR-SAF-02, section 9.2
Cleaning sign-off	AUR-SAF-02, section 9.3
Faults and maintenance	Maintenance log; AUR-SOP-09
Incidents and near misses	AUR-SAF-04 Incident Report Form

All guest information is handled under AUR-SAF-03 and the UAE Personal Data Protection Law.